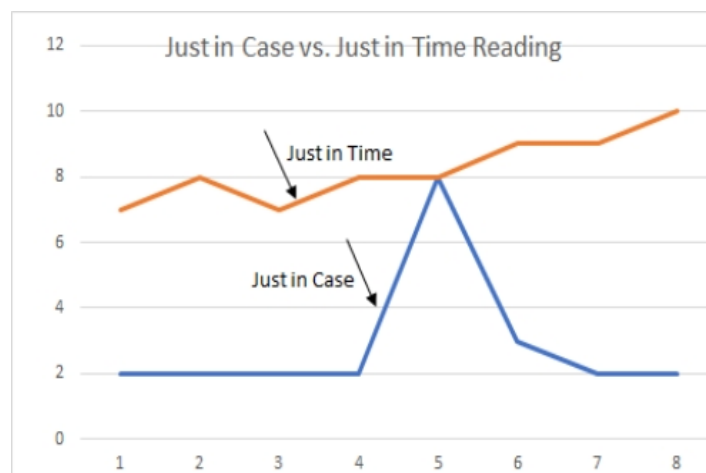


Filtering the information you need (Information Diet)

Tim Ferriss expounds on information diet in ‘The Four Hour Workweek’ and elaborates on Meta-learning in ‘Four Hour Chef’. We are going to combine both ideas and ensure we have time for everything in our lives.

Let’s say you are looking to buy a house. Your conscious brain will take in every kind of information you hear or see, related to houses and the real estate market. Like a fish that takes in water it needs and filters out unwanted stuff, you only see real estate news. The brain filters information through the RAD – Reticular Articulating Device. This is the filter that blocks any unimportant information that the conscious mind does not need. You wouldn’t normally do this on a given Sunday but the RAD makes sure the information you need, pops out of TV advertisements, Newspaper articles, Internet Blogs right into your conscious-memory storage. This happens only when you have a time-constraint coupled with a strong need. But as we scroll every-day through our Newsfeed and other online content locations, we tire out our brains with needless information. Just look back to your University days when we used to study at the last minute for our exams. Parkinson’s law proves that “ *work expands so as to fill the time available for its completion.*” When we have a time constraint our goal fits the time remaining and our brain starts to process things faster.



The next time you start browsing mindlessly, note that you won’t remember 99% of what you are providing to your brain. When we probe internally for the reason why we do this: reasons are that mindless scrolling fulfills two high-placed criteria on the Maslow Needs Hierarchy. They fulfill